14.Exploring Pro-Code Extension of a Zoho Creator Application Using Zoho Catalyst / Custom Functions

Aim

To extend the functionality of the Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application by integrating pro-code backend capabilities through Zoho Catalyst and custom Deluge functions, enabling advanced computation, external API integration, and heavy data processing.

Theory

Zoho Creator provides low-code development features such as forms, reports, workflows, and Deluge scripting. However, complex enterprise requirements may need additional backend processing.

1. Custom Deluge Functions:

Custom Deluge functions allow developers to implement reusable business logic within Zoho Creator. They can automate claim-processing tasks, validate claim information, calculate settlement amounts, and communicate with external REST APIs.

Benefits:

- Automates insurance claim processing.
- Reduces repeated code.
- Supports integration with external services.

2. Zoho Catalyst Serverless Pro-Code Integration:

Zoho Catalyst is a serverless development platform that supports backend development using languages such as Java, Node.js, and Python. It can handle computationally intensive tasks that may exceed the capabilities of standard low-code workflows.
In the insurance application, Catalyst could support advanced fraud detection, complex claim calculations, document processing, and integration with external insurance services.

Benefits:

- Supports custom backend logic.
- Enables advanced computation.
- Helps separate complex processing from the main application.

Procedure

Step 1: Creating a Custom Deluge Function in Zoho Creator

1. Open the Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application in Zoho Creator.
2. Navigate to the application setup or Logic section.
3. Select Functions and click Create Function.
4. Define the function name, return type, and input arguments.
5. Write the Deluge script for a task such as validating claim information or calculating an approved settlement amount.
6. Test the function using the available code executor and save it.
7. Associate the function with the appropriate claim form workflow, if required.

Step 2: Initializing and Setting Up a Zoho Catalyst Project

1. Log in to the Zoho Catalyst Console.
2. Create a new project.
3. Configure a serverless function using the supported development tools.
4. Write a backend function for an advanced insurance operation, such as claim analysis or document processing.
5. Test the function and prepare it for deployment.

Step 3: Connecting Zoho Creator with Zoho Catalyst via API / Integration

1. Deploy the Catalyst function and obtain its API endpoint.
2. Open the Connections section in Zoho Creator.
3. Configure a secure connection to the Catalyst service using the supported authentication method.
4. Create a custom Deluge function that sends claim information to the endpoint using invokeurl.
5. Map the necessary fields, such as Claim ID, Claim Type, and Claim Amount Requested.
6. Process the response and store the result in the appropriate field, where required.

Ilustrative Deluge example:

```
response = invokeurl
[
   url: "YOUR_CATALYST_API_ENDPOINT"
   type: POST
   parameters: {
      "recordId": input.ID,
      "claimAmount": input.Claim_Amount_Requested
   }
   connection: "catalyst_connection"
];
```

Step 4: Test and Validate the Integration

1. Submit a test claim using fictional data.
2. Verify that the form workflow triggers the custom function.
3. Confirm that the claim information reaches the Catalyst backend.
4. Check that the backend processes the request and returns the expected response.
5. Verify that the returned result is handled correctly in Zoho Creator.
6. Review execution logs and correct any errors.

Result

The Insurance Claim Request & Processing Management application can be extended using custom Deluge functions and Zoho Catalyst to support advanced claim calculations, external API integrations, and computationally intensive backend operations.